

“A CIO SHOULD HAVE DIGITISATION ON HIS AGENDA”

Digital India is seen as a great opportunity by most organisations, but how it will eventually shape up is something that we will all have to wait and watch. However, companies like Cisco are fully geared up to get on the bandwagon with their digital strategy and technology solutions, and are viewing it as an initiative that will change the entire technology landscape. In a conversation with *Open Source For You*, **Sanjay Kaul, MD, service provider business, Cisco India and SAARC**, shared the company's initiatives with respect to the Digital India movement. Excerpts:

Sanjay Kaul, MD, service provider business, Cisco India and SAARC



Q How does Cisco plan to participate in the Digital India movement?

We are already into it. We have been involved in architecting the strategies for key stakeholders. For us, the journey started three years ago, with our concept of the 'Internet of Everything'. We are working with service providers, setting up their connectivity layer, which is the foundation for Digital India. IP is what we have been doing for many decades, and I think that is what we are promoting — an end-to-end IP architecture. This is the first layer towards making Digital India happen, because on top of that connectivity layer, which is end-to-end IP, one can put an evolved service platform. That is where you can define how to extract value out of the connectivity layer. So for us the journey has already begun — we are in the midst of it.

I think something great that happened is that the government has now carved out a vision, which is phenomenal, and we totally believe in it. We are now moving from planning to execution. We are working on a number of fronts. We are working with service providers, states, municipalities, manufacturing hubs, and we see opportunities and projects all over the place. So, digitisation is happening and it is happening at a very fast pace.

Q How do you see the Internet of Things (IoT) space evolving with the Digital India concept? Do you see Cisco as a key player in the IoT revolution?

If you look back, the Internet of Everything or IoE was a slogan coined by John Chaves, who is our chairman. We always believed that digitisation has to happen, and I think